

OneDrive & Office 365 Setup

Your Professional Digital Workspace — Instructor Solution

Gerrish School of Business · Endicott College · Fall 2026

Connect to Prior Knowledge

Before this course begins, you have likely used some form of digital storage — a personal Google Drive, a USB stick, or just your laptop's desktop. Those habits worked for high school, but the professional world runs on a different standard. In BUS123 you will use **Microsoft 365** and **Endicott OneDrive** for everything — not because it's required, but because it's what employers use, what collaborators expect, and what makes you look organized and capable from day one.

Concept Overview

What Is Microsoft 365?

Microsoft 365 is a subscription-based suite of professional productivity tools. Your Endicott email address gives you full access at no cost.

Application	Primary Use	Used in BUS123?
Excel	Spreadsheets, data, financial models	■ Core tool
Word	Documents, reports, memos	Occasionally
PowerPoint	Presentations, slide decks	Occasionally
Teams	Chat, video, file sharing	As needed
OneDrive	Cloud file storage and sync	■ Required

What Is OneDrive?

OneDrive is Microsoft's cloud storage platform. Your Endicott account provides **1 terabyte (TB)** of storage. Files saved to OneDrive sync automatically to any device where you are signed in and are protected against hardware failure.

■ A key difference from Google Drive: OneDrive files can be opened in full desktop applications (Excel, Word, PowerPoint), not just browser versions. This matters for complex Excel workbooks that require full functionality.

Saving vs. Syncing — An Important Distinction

Saving a file to your OneDrive folder is **not** the same as it being backed up to the cloud. The file must also sync. A **green checkmark** on the file icon confirms it is synced. A spinning icon means the upload is still in progress.

Icon	Status	Meaning
■ Green checkmark	Synced	Safely backed up to cloud
■ Spinning arrows	Syncing	Upload in progress — wait before closing laptop
■ Red X	Error	Sync failed — check OneDrive for details

The Required BUS123 Folder Structure

Inside your Endicott OneDrive, create a BUS123 folder with subfolders for each module.

- OneDrive – Endicott College
 - **BUS123**
 - Module 01 – Intro
 - Module 02 – Excel Basics
 - Module 03 – Business Math
 - Homework
 - Projects

■ File naming rule: every submitted file must include your last name. Example: Smith_M01_L01_Setup.xlsx — never "Untitled" or "HW1".

Key Reference

Action	Where / How	Notes
Install Office 365	office.com → Sign In → Install Office	Use Endicott email
Open OneDrive	Search "OneDrive" in Start / Applications	Sign in with Endicott email

Action	Where / How	Notes
Save to OneDrive	File → Save As → OneDrive — Endicott	Navigate to BUS123 folder
Turn on Auto-Save	Toggle in top-left of Excel/Word	Only works when file is in OneDrive
Access from browser	office.com or onedrive.live.com	Sign in → full apps available
Version history	File → Info → Version History	Restore any version up to 30 days back



Check Your Understanding

Answer these 7 questions after reading. Answers appear at the end of this document.

1. What is the primary advantage of saving files to OneDrive rather than to your laptop's Desktop folder?

2. Your classmate signs into OneDrive using their personal Hotmail account. What problem will this cause, and what should they do instead?

3. You save a file to your OneDrive folder at 11:55pm for a midnight deadline. The sync icon is still spinning. Is your submission safe? Explain.

4. List three Microsoft 365 applications and describe the primary use of each.

5. What does the green checkmark on a file in OneDrive indicate?

6. You accidentally delete all the data in your Excel file and save it. Is the original data recoverable? How?

7. Why is Google Drive not an acceptable substitute for OneDrive in this course?

Key Vocabulary

Microsoft 365

A cloud-based subscription suite of productivity applications including Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Teams, and OneDrive. Accessed via your Endicott email credentials.

OneDrive

Microsoft's cloud file storage and synchronization service. Files saved to OneDrive are automatically backed up and accessible from any internet-connected device.

Cloud Storage

File storage hosted on remote servers rather than on a local device. Provides accessibility, backup protection, and collaboration capabilities.

Sync

The process of uploading a locally saved file to the cloud server so that the cloud copy matches the local copy. Indicated by a green checkmark icon.

Auto-Save

A feature in Excel and Word that continuously saves changes to a OneDrive file in real time, eliminating the risk of losing unsaved work.

Version History

A OneDrive feature that automatically stores previous versions of a file for up to 30 days, allowing any prior version to be restored at any time.

Folder Structure

A hierarchical organization system for files using nested folders. A consistent folder structure enables fast file retrieval and reflects professional file management habits.

Answer Key — Check Your Understanding

■ Instructor use only. Do not distribute to students.

1.

OneDrive stores files in the cloud and syncs them across all devices. A Desktop file exists only on one machine — if that machine is lost, broken, or reset, the file is permanently gone. OneDrive protects against hardware failure and enables access from any device.

2.

A personal Hotmail/Outlook.com account connects to personal OneDrive storage (5GB limit, not IT-supported). They should sign out and sign back in using their Endicott email (firstname.lastname@endicott.edu) to access the school's 1TB OneDrive.

3.

Not necessarily safe. Saving a file locally and syncing it to the cloud are two separate steps. If the sync is still in progress, the cloud copy does not yet reflect the latest changes. They should wait for the green checkmark before closing the laptop.

4.

Any three of: Excel (spreadsheets and data analysis), Word (documents and reports), PowerPoint (presentations), Teams (communication and collaboration), OneDrive (cloud storage and sync).

5.

The green checkmark confirms that the file has been successfully synced to the cloud. The local copy and the cloud copy are identical.

6.

Yes — recoverable. OneDrive stores version history for up to 30 days. File → Info → Version History shows all prior saved versions. Clicking any version and selecting Restore returns the file to that state.

7.

Google Drive and Microsoft Excel are incompatible ecosystems. Converting between Google Sheets and Excel often causes loss of formatting, formulas, or features. Since BUS123 requires full Excel functionality, all files must remain in OneDrive.